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Learn how to encrypt all your internet usage on your Android phones with this article

MeeGo 1.2 is here

MeeGo mobile operating system has been upgraded to version 1.2 and features SIM Application toolkit, more Bluetooth profiles, and wireless authentication methods

Sennheiser HD 598

The bassier German

The successor to the best-selling HD 595 has been due for a while. The HD 598 is the cheapest among circumaural consumer headphones. The HD 598 is attractive looking with a cream-coloured headband and earcups. Build quality is strictly so-so. They're quite comfortable with a luxurious headband and despite the strong clamping force the soft ear padding cushions your head.

The HD 598 sounds best amped with a solid state amp, since they tend to be a little lush, but they'll sound fine out of an audio out port, unlike the much tougher to drive HD 800 that we reviewed recently. They also don't scale up with progressively

better equipment like the HD 800. However, they're a lot more source forgiving. There is a slight hump in the mid bass, and on account of this, the bass notes tend to have more emphasis. Bass is reasonably tight, but not taut and springy, and fast bass notes have noticeable overhang. There is a bit of sibilance to some vocals, particularly noticeable on quieter tracks like Led Zeppelin's Stairway To Heaven. If you're a music enthusiast, you'll enjoy the HD 598, if you have a good system and a ₹9,000 headphone amp, you will enjoy them a bit more, as long as the amp's neutral. The soundstage is pretty compressed, and you really need to concentrate before you can imagine



instruments around you. If you're really discerning about nitty-gritty details, the HD 598 will not satisfy, but neither will anything else at that price.

For a price of ₹12,990, the HD 598 is already beyond the shopping range of most headphone buyers. If they're in your budget, they're a good buy as they aren't very fussy with equipment and sources, and will give you a true peep into the world of mid-to-high fidelity sound.

Michael Browne

Specifications

Freq. response: 12-38500 Hz; Sound pressure: 112 dB; Impedance: 50 ohms; Weight 270 grams; Cable length: 3 meters

Contact

Sennheiser Electronics India Private Ltd.

Email: saahil.kumar@sennheiserindia.com

Web site: www.sennheiserindia.com

Price: ₹12,990

7.0/10

Features 7.0
Performance 7.5
Build Quality 6.5
Value for money 6.0

Specifications

Socket: LGA 1155; Expansion slots: 4xPCIe x16, 2xPCI, 1xPCIe x1; RAM: 4 DIMM slots supporting upto 32GB; Audio: Realtek ALC889 codec

Contact

GIGABYTE India

Phone: 91 22 4063 3222

Email: anilkumarr@gigabyte.in

Web site: www.gigabyte.in

Price: ₹20,000

7.0/10

Features 7.0
Performance 7.0
Build Quality 8.0
Value for money 5.0

Gigabyte Z68X UD7 B3

Enthusiast board with SSD caching

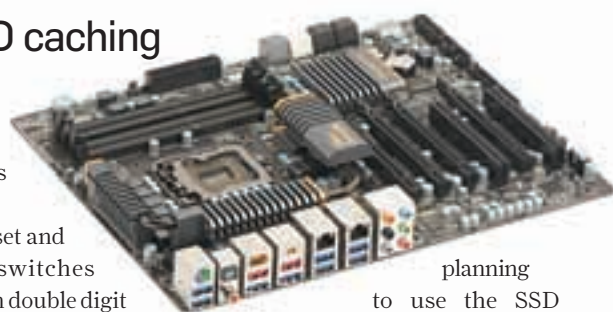
The unanimous gripe most users had with the P67 chipset, was that it wouldn't allow you to use the integrated Intel HD graphics of the Sandy Bridge processors. With the Z68 chipset Intel allows just that. But strangely, this Gigabyte board doesn't have any display ports. So in essence, it's just like a P67 board, but with added features such as the Smart Response Technology (SRT) which allows you to use upto 64GB from your SSD for read/write caching for your HDD or RAID array.

Build quality of the board is absolutely stunning with solid state capacitors, sturdy heat-

sinks, etc. It also has dedicated power, reset and CMOS switches along with double digit debugging LEDs.

As far as performance goes, we didn't find it to be drastically different from the Gigabyte P67-UD7 board that we'd tested. PC Mark Vantage gave an overall score of 18504 (19471 for P67-UD7), and Cinebench R10 gave a multi-CPU rendering score of 18976 (19200 for the P67-UD7).

So who is this board meant for? Existing P67 board users should upgrade only if they're



planning to use the SSD caching feature. For someone looking to build an enthusiast Sandy Bridge system, this board makes sense assuming that this user won't be bothering with the internal graphics. For ₹20,000 we would suggest you wait for a board which, at least, has the Lucid Virtu license. It will enable you to use the internal graphics, despite the display port being connected to the discrete GPU.

Nimish Sawant